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Hiring Team
Keystone
26 Throgmorton Street, 1st Floor
London EC2N 2AN
Re: Full Time Economist 2027 (Greenhouse 8211974)

Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the Full Time Economist 2027 role in Keystone's London office. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at HKUST, specializing in empirical industrial organization and digital economics, and I expect to graduate in June 2027 (I can accelerate if an earlier start would help). Keystone's digital-competition work is exactly where I want to apply this training: the UK advertisers' claim that Google used its buy-side tools (Google Ads and DV360) and its publisher ad server (DFP) to steer open-web display transactions through its own exchange, AdX, is precisely the kind of multi-sided platform and self-preferencing question I want to work on as an economist.

The posting calls for economists who can turn large data and economic frameworks into clear arguments in high-stakes litigation and regulatory settings; that is how my research already works. My job market paper asks a platform-design question with the same structure as a conduct case—how a platform's rules change behavior, and who gains and who pays. Using Taobao apparel transactions (2017–2023; six apparel categories), I clean large transaction data, estimate a structural model of purchase, return-shipping-insurance take-up, and return decisions, and rank policies by seller profit, consumer surplus, and social welfare. With Professors Kohei Kawaguchi and Kei Kawai, I study pricing and inventory under resale price maintenance—a vertical-restraint question in the same family as the Google claim—combining descriptive evidence, regressions, and a dynamic oligopoly model built from monthly bookstore point-of-sale records across 1,000+ stores.

Both projects run on reproducible pipelines in Python, R, and C++ on AWS and HPC/SLURM; I test assumptions, validate estimates, and state clearly what the numbers imply for the next decision. My broader toolkit includes merger simulation, market entry and exit counterfactuals, and firm-conduct identification. As lecturer for HKUST's MSc Math Camp (rated 4.53/5), I am also practiced at explaining technical material clearly to non-specialist audiences—the same skill a client-facing economist needs.

I have attached my CV and would be glad to provide my job market paper or any further materials. Thank you for your consideration; I would welcome the chance to discuss how my research fits Keystone's work.

Sincerely,

Ke-Cheng Hsu (Clio)